



Choose the Class Exhibit: Opinion with Evidence

Grade 4 • Connecticut • Writing

4.W.1

Organize an opinion and support reasons with provided facts and details. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 4 • Connecticut • Writing; 4.W.1. Focus: Organize an opinion and support reasons with provided facts and details.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

Use an opinion, organized reasons, supporting details, linking phrases, and a conclusion. A reason tells why; a fact or detail makes that reason concrete. Both choices below can produce a strong response. Evaluate the writing's support, not whether you agree with the choice.

Model 1 • Reason: “A map exhibit is interactive.” Add support from invented facts: visitors can move labels.

A map exhibit is interactive because visitors can place the movable labels on the map.

Model 2 • Is “Everyone will love it” supported by that fact?

No. A feature does not prove every visitor's reaction. Use a limited claim such as visitors can participate.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Fictional exhibit brief

Oak Class has one display table and a budget of \$30. A Weather Journal exhibit costs \$18: it uses ten student observation pages and three hand-drawn charts. Visitors can compare patterns. A Story Design exhibit costs \$24: it uses six original story openings and reusable character cards. Visitors can combine cards to suggest new plots. Either exhibit fits the table. The class has two afternoons to prepare. These are invented planning details, not research findings.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. State the choice and audience for an opinion letter.

2. Write a clear opinion.

3. List two reasons for your choice.

4. Match one fact to each reason.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. Which exhibit costs less, and by how much?

6. Does lower cost alone prove better learning? Explain.

7. Write a topic sentence for your first reason.

8. Add a factual supporting sentence.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Write a second reason paragraph of two sentences.

10. Connect your reasons with in addition or for instance.

11. Correct: "The Story Design costs \$18."

12. Improve: "Every visitor will become a great author."



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. A classmate prefers the other choice. Name one real advantage it has.

14. Write a conclusion related to your opinion.

15. Draft a two-paragraph letter using at least three facts.

16. Audit your letter: mark each fact and revise an unsupported claim.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. New brief: a timeline display costs \$10; an audio display costs \$22. Budget is \$20. Recommend one.

18. Give one reason and its supporting fact.

19. Write a sentence linking the reason to the opinion.

20. Write a fitting conclusion.



Answers and response criteria

1. Choose the class exhibit; audience could be teacher/class planning team.
2. Either exhibit, named in a complete position statement.
3. Example Weather: lower cost, comparison activity. Story: creative participation, reuse of cards. Both must fit brief.
4. Weather: \$18/\$30, ten pages/three charts; Story: plot-card interaction, reusable cards. Require actual support.
5. Weather Journal costs \$6 less: $24 - 18 = 6$.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. No. Cost supports affordability, not an automatic learning outcome.
7. Example: The Weather Journal keeps spending low. Must connect to opinion.
8. Example: It costs \$18 of our \$30 budget.
9. Clear different reason plus a relevant detail from brief.
10. In addition adds a reason; for instance introduces evidence. Require correct logical use.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. The Story Design costs \$24.

12. Example: Visitors can practice suggesting plots with character cards. Avoid unsupported guarantee.

13. Weather lower cost/charts; Story creative interactive/reusable cards. Fairly represent other option.

14. Restates recommendation and strongest reason without new unsupported claims.

15. Require opinion, grouped reasons, ≥ 3 accurate brief details, linking language, and conclusion.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Accept correctly marked details and a revision limiting/removing an overclaim.
17. Timeline is affordable; audio exceeds budget unless changed. Other recommendation must acknowledge constraint.
18. Timeline fits budget because $\$10 \leq \20 ; or audio would need at least \$2 cost reduction.
19. Coherent because/therefore/for instance link with accurate amounts.
20. Returns to recommendation; no invented promise about learning or popularity.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/sde/language-arts/ct-core-standards/ct-core-standards-for-ela-at-a-glance-grade-4.pdf?rev=98e99f6998a342c4a252c5f77fdafe94>

Research limit: official released-assessment retrieval was unsuccessful in this run. This packet is standards-focused classroom instruction; it makes no released-test alignment, timing, or scoring claim.

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